Chief Technology Officer (CTO)

Aerospace Company

About the Company

We are a mid-sized aerospace company that designs, develops, and produces systems for defense and commercial programs. Our work includes airframe structures, avionics, propulsion subsystems, and mission systems integration. We have engineering, manufacturing, and test operations at multiple U.S. sites and serve government agencies, prime contractors, and commercial aviation customers.

Role Summary

The Chief Technology Officer reports to the Chief Executive Officer and is a member of the executive leadership team. The CTO sets the company's technology direction, leads its research and development and engineering organizations, and serves as the senior technical representative to customers, partners, and regulators. The CTO is responsible for making sure the company's technical capabilities support its business strategy and that all technical work meets applicable export-control, security, and quality requirements.

Key Responsibilities

- Define and maintain the company's technology strategy and multi-year technology roadmap in line with business objectives and customer needs.
- Lead the research and development and engineering organizations, including organizational design, staffing, budgets, and performance management.
- Oversee investment decisions for internal research and development, and set priorities across defense and commercial programs.
- Serve as the senior technical point of contact for government and commercial customers, including technical reviews, proposals, and program briefings.
- Develop and manage the company's intellectual property strategy, including patent filings, trade secret protection, and licensing.
- Ensure that engineering processes and technical data handling comply with ITAR, EAR, and applicable industrial security requirements.
- Lead technical due diligence for mergers, acquisitions, partnerships, and major supplier decisions.
- Brief the Chief Executive Officer and Board of Directors on technical risks, opportunities, and progress against the roadmap.

Required Qualifications

- 15 or more years of professional experience in the aerospace or defense industry, or in an adjacent engineering industry.
- 10 or more years leading engineering or technical organizations, including management of people and budgets.
- Demonstrated experience managing technical relationships with government and/or commercial customers.
- B.S. in Aerospace Engineering, Mechanical Engineering, Electrical Engineering, Computer Science, Physics, or a closely related engineering discipline.
- Must be a U.S. Person as defined under ITAR (22 CFR 120.62). The company cannot sponsor employment visas for this role.
- Strong verbal and written communication skills, including executive briefings and technical documentation.

Preferred Qualifications

- M.S. or Ph.D. in one of the fields listed above.
- Active U.S. security clearance (Secret or higher), or the ability to obtain one.
- Publications and/or patents in aerospace or an adjacent technical field.

Compensation and Benefits

- Base salary range: $275,000–$350,000, plus annual incentive compensation.
- Benefits include medical, dental, and vision insurance; a 401(k) plan with company match; life and disability insurance; paid time off and holidays; and tuition assistance.

Equal Opportunity Statement

The company is an Equal Opportunity Employer. All qualified applicants will receive consideration for employment without regard to race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, age, disability, protected veteran status, or any other characteristic protected by applicable law.